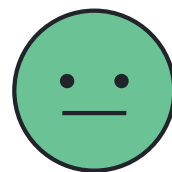
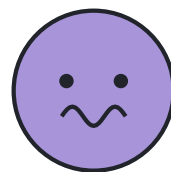
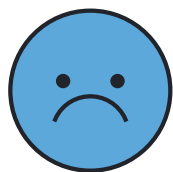


TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



Motivated Mind

Focus, Goals & Beating Procrastination - A Teen Workbook

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



How This Book Works

Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 Understanding Motivation
- 2 My Focus & Habits
- 3 Goal-Setting
- 4 Beating Procrastination
- 5 Real-Life Scenarios
- 6 Reflection & Plan



Part 1: Understanding Motivation

Motivation follows action more than it leads it.



Waiting to 'Feel Like It'

A trap many people fall into: waiting to feel motivated before starting. But motivation often shows up AFTER you begin, not before. Starting - even badly, even for two minutes - is usually what unlocks the momentum.

There are two kinds of motivation: outside rewards (grades, praise) and inside drivers (curiosity, values, growth). Inside motivation lasts longer, so it helps to connect tasks to something you actually care about.

Motivation myths vs. truths

- ☐ Myth: I need to feel motivated first. Truth: action creates motivation.
- ☐ Myth: I should do it all at once. Truth: small steps beat big bursts.
- ☐ Myth: I'm just lazy. Truth: usually it's fear, overwhelm, or no clear next step.



Why We Procrastinate

Procrastination usually isn't laziness - it's often the brain avoiding a task that feels hard, boring, unclear, or scary (fear of failing). Understanding the real reason helps you pick the right fix.

The cure is rarely 'try harder.' It's usually 'make the first step smaller and clearer,' or 'deal with the feeling that's making you avoid it.'

Common procrastination causes

- ☐ The task feels too big - shrink it.
- ☐ It's unclear - define the next tiny step.
- ☐ Fear of doing it wrong - allow a rough draft.
- ☐ Too many distractions - remove them.



Part 2: My Focus & Habits

Notice what helps and what steals your focus.



My Focus & Motivation Check

Rate how true each has been lately.

1 = Never 5 = Always

I start tasks without endless delay.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I can focus without constantly checking my phone.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I break big tasks into steps.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I finish what I start.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I know why my goals matter to me.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I bounce back after an off day.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

What my answers tell me



My Procrastination Log

When you feel stressed or overwhelmed, logging it helps you understand your triggers and what actually helps. Fill one row when a stressful moment happens.

- 1** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 2** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 3** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 4** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____



Part 3: Goal-Setting

Clear goals beat vague wishes.



Make Goals SMART

A goal like 'do better in school' is too fuzzy to act on. SMART goals are Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound - so you know exactly what to do and when you've done it.

Break big goals into small milestones. Each small win fuels the next.

Fuzzy vs. SMART

- ☐ Fuzzy: 'Study more.' SMART: 'Review 10 flashcards after dinner, Mon-Thu.'
- ☐ Fuzzy: 'Get fit.' SMART: 'Walk 20 minutes, 3 days this week.'



My Goal & Why It Matters

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week



Part 4: Beating Procrastination

Small steps, fewer distractions.

Anti-Procrastination Toolkit



Tick strategies to try; star what works for you.

Shrink it

- ☐ Do just the first 2 minutes.
- ☐ Break the task into the smallest next step.
- ☐ Lower the bar: allow a messy first attempt.

Focus it

- ☐ Work in short sprints (e.g. 25 min) then break.
- ☐ Put your phone in another room.
- ☐ Turn off notifications while you work.

Reward it

- ☐ Plan a small reward after finishing.
- ☐ Track your streak of started tasks.
- ☐ Tell someone your plan for accountability.



Reframing 'I Can't Be Bothered'

Our thoughts shape our feelings. Sometimes an automatic thought is unhelpful or untrue. You can CATCH the thought, CHECK if it's fair and true, and CHANGE it into a more balanced one. This is a skill - it gets easier with practice.

1. The situation (just the facts):

2. The automatic thought that popped up:

3. The feeling it gave me (and how strong, 0-10):

4. Check it: Is it 100% true? What's the evidence? Am I mind-reading or catastrophizing?

5. A more balanced, fair thought:

6. How I feel now:



Part 5: Real-Life Scenarios

Get moving in real life.



Motivation Situations (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 A big project is due and you keep putting it off.

What could you do?

2 You can't focus because your phone keeps pulling you away.

What could you do?

3 You feel overwhelmed and don't know where to start.

What could you do?



Motivation Situations (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1** You had one bad day and want to quit a goal entirely.

What could you do?

- 2** The task is boring but has to get done.

What could you do?

- 3** You're scared of doing it wrong, so you avoid it.

What could you do?

My Motivation Plan



Your plan to start, focus, and finish.

A goal that matters to me:

The very next 2-minute step:

Distractions I'll remove:

My reward and accountability:

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

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Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week

Checking In With Myself



What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:

A Letter to Future Me



Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

My Notes & Reflections



Lined area for notes and reflections, consisting of 20 horizontal lines.



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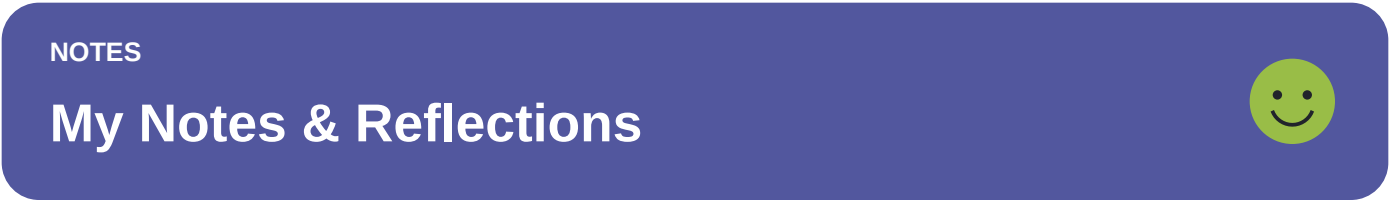
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A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.

NOTES

My Notes & Reflections



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My Notes & Reflections



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, spanning the width of the page below the header.



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